

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

PRIME MINISTER INDIRA GANDHI MODULE-8



INDO-PAK WAR OF 1965



- The Indo-Pakistan War of 1965 highlighted one of Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri's greatest moments as leader of the nation.
- The war began when Pakistan claimed half of the Kutch peninsular.
- Pakistan took advantage of the fact that the border had been delineated, though not demarcated in the swampy region.

1965 WAR WITH PAKISTAN



- In 1965, Pakistan President Ayub Khan decided to begin insurrection in the Indian part of Kashmir leading to a war between India and Pakistan.
- The objective was to annex Indian side of Kashmir or bring in international intervention.
- Pakistan planned 'Operation Gibraltar' whereby warring units were created to train Kashmiri militants in the use of small arms.
- They attacked public property like bridges and government installations. The intention was to create confusion and spark unrest.

1965 WAR WITH PAKISTAN



- But when that was not very successful, Pakistan launched its reserve plan codenamed '**Operation Grand Slam**' under which troops from Pakistan crossed the Jammu ceasefire line and entered Indian side using heavy artillery.
- Indians fought back in the **Uri sector** and succeeded in capturing the pass of **Haji Pir**.
- On 1 September, Pakistan launched an armed offensive in **Chhambal** where an infantry division with two regiments of American Patton tanks crossed the border and took the Indians by surprise.
- The objective was to capture the bridge at **Akhnoor** and sever the links between **Jammu and Kashmir** and **Punjab**.

1965 WAR WITH PAKISTAN



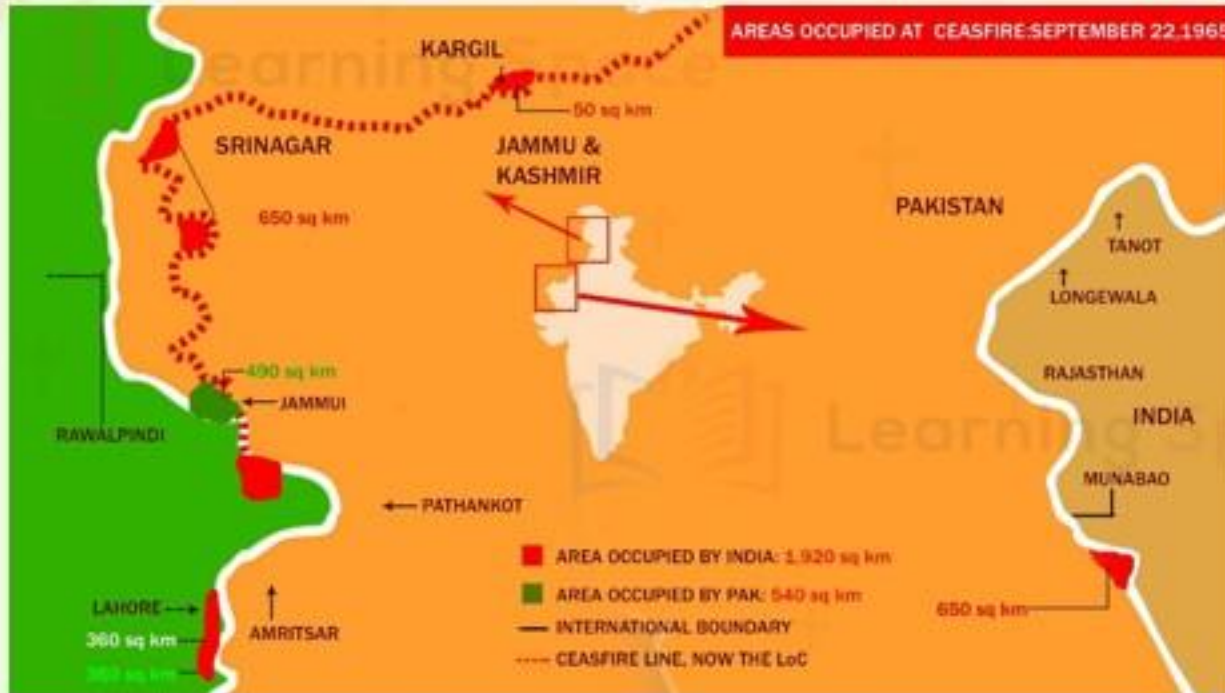
- The battle took place in two fronts in the north-west- Kashmir and Punjab.
- On 5th September, the Indian army was asked to attack from a new front.
- On 6th several tank regiments crossed the border and reached Lahore.
- Overhead, the aeroplanes destroyed the enemy's bases.
- The Chinese supported the government of Pakistan and condemned the Indian actions and named them as Indian imperialism and that they pose a threat to South Asia.

ROLE OF PM SHASTRI



- PM Shastri said that India had no intentions of causing trouble with its bordering neighbors, and that the country's focus of utilising its limited resources was for the economic progress.
 - But under the possibility of an incursion, the government would be quite clear in its objective of protecting the nation, and its duty in this regard would be wilfully and uncompromisingly discharged.
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- During the war, PM Shastri coined the slogan 'Jai Jawaan Jai Kisan' (Hail the Soldier, Hail the Farmer) in a bid to boost the morale of the Indian Army, and to encourage the farmers to do their best to increase food production of grains for reducing imports.

ROLE OF PM SHASTRI



- The war with Pakistan went on for 5 months, between April and September of 1965.
- Ultimately, on 23 September, 1965, UN declared a ceasefire ending the war between India and Pakistan.

- In 1966, Soviet Union decided to mediate between India and Pakistan and PM Shastri and Ayub Khan met in Tashkent and signed the agreement on 10 January 1966 to give away the conquered regions of each other by both parties, and return to the 1949 ceasefire line in Kashmir.

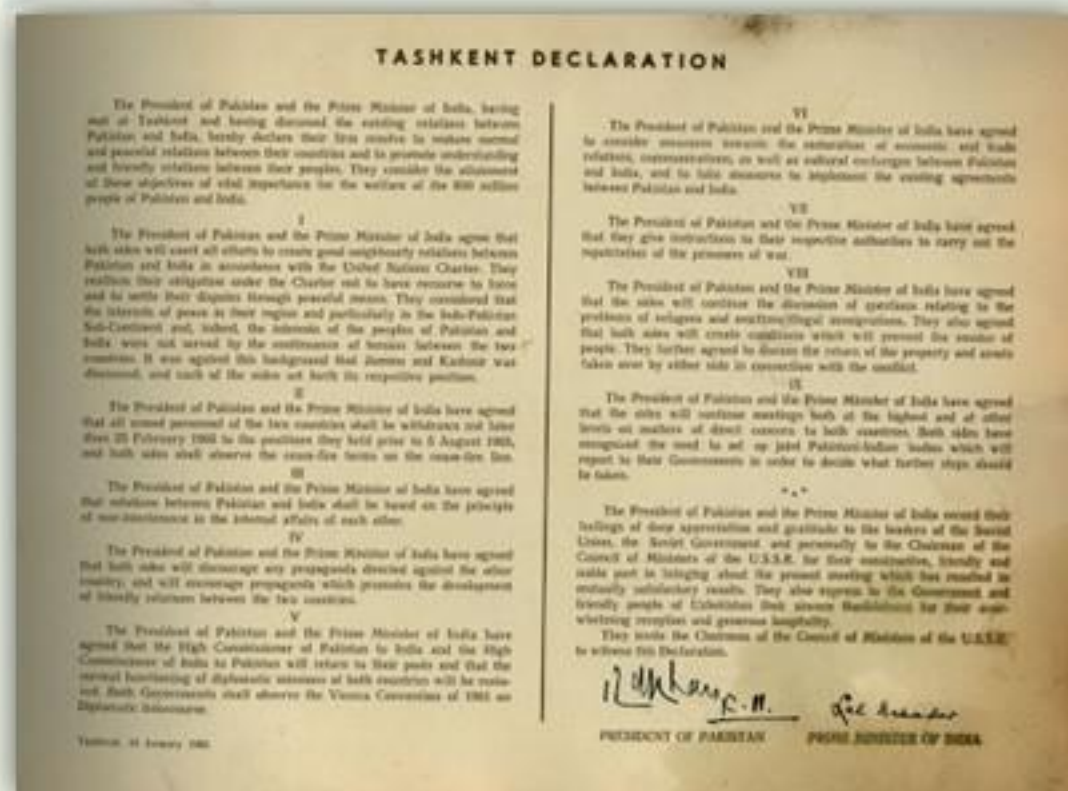
TASHKENT AGREEMENT

The Prime Minister of India and the President of Pakistan met at Tashkent and on January 10, 1966 discussed relations between the two countries. According to the Tashkent Declaration (as provided by the MEA):



- The Prime Minister of India and the President of Pakistan agreed that both sides would exert all efforts to create good neighborly relations between India and Pakistan in accordance with the United Nations Charter.
- They reaffirmed their obligation under the Charter not to have recourse to force and to settle their disputes through peaceful means.

TASHKENT AGREEMENT



- The Prime Minister of India and the President of Pakistan have agreed that all armed personnel of the two countries shall be withdrawn not later than 25 February, 1966 to the positions they held prior to 5 August, 1965, and both sides shall observe the cease-fire terms on the cease-fire line.

- The relations between India and Pakistan would be based on the principle of non-interference in the internal affairs of each other.

TASHKENT AGREEMENT



- Normal functioning of diplomatic missions of both countries would be restored. Both Governments would observe the Vienna Convention of 1961 on Diplomatic Intercourse.
- The Prime Minister of India and the President of Pakistan had agreed to consider measures towards the restoration of economic and trade relations, communications, as well as cultural exchanges between India and Pakistan.
- The Prime Minister of India and the President of Pakistan agreed that the sides would continue the discussion of questions relating to the problems of refugees and evictions/illegal immigrations and gave instructions to their respective authorities to carry out the repatriation of the prisoners of war. They also agreed that both sides would create conditions which will prevent the exodus of people.

TASHKENT AGREEMENT



- The leaders expressed their feelings of deep appreciation and gratitude to the leader of the Soviet Union, for their constructive, friendly and noble part in bringing about the present meeting which had resulted in mutually satisfactory results.
- India and Pakistan were under pressure to peacefully resolve the dispute from USSR, UN and US.
- In India, people were disappointed with the agreement as it did not contain a 'No War' clause. Soon after 1965, India went on a war against Pakistan in 1971.

MYSTERY OF SHASTRI'S DEATH



- Soon after signing the agreement, PM Shastri passed away. Although officially it was maintained that Shastri died of heart attack, his widow, Lalita Shastri kept alleging that her husband was poisoned.
- Many believed that Shastri's body turning blue was an evidence of his poisoning.
- Indeed a Russian butler attending to him was arrested on suspicion of poisoning Shastri, but was later absolved of charges.
- The government also admitted that no postmortem examination had been conducted on him in USSR, but it did have a report of a medical investigation conducted by Shastri's personal physician Dr. R.N. Chugh and some Russian doctors.

PM SHASTRI



- All his lifetime, PM Shastri was known for honesty and humility.
- He was the first person to have been posthumously awarded the Bharat Ratna, and a memorial "Vijay Ghat" was built for him in Delhi.
- Several educational institutes, like Shastri National Academy of Administration (Mussorie), were named after him.
- The Shastri Indo-Canadian Institute was named after him due to his role in promoting scholarly activity between India and Canada.

PRIME MINISTER INDIRA GANDHI

1966 – 1977

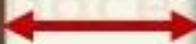
1980 – 1984



PM INDIRA GANDHI

- After the death of PM Shastri, Gulzarilal Nanda was sworn in again as the interim Prime Minister.
- The Congress President thought of swearing in Indira Gandhi as the next Prime Minister.
- Although she had little administrative experience, it was accepted that her candidacy would be largely accepted.
- Morarji Desai also wanted to contest for the post of the Prime Minister.
- Ultimately, with the support of Congress Parliamentary Party, Indira Gandhi was sworn in as the Prime Minister in January 1966. Indira Gandhi came to power with the support of two-thirds of the party MP's votes in the secret ballot.

Morarji Desai
Former CM of
Bombay.



Indira Gandhi

- Former Congress President.
- Union Minister for Information.



GENERAL ELECTION OF 1967 - BACKGROUND



- The fourth general election of 1967 was the first general election held after JL Nehru's death.
- In 1966, religion and language issues had affected the political landscape.
- On the economic side, food shortage and inflation had been plaguing the economy.

GENERAL ELECTION OF 1967 - BACKGROUND



- Depletion of foreign exchange
 - Drop in industrial production and exports
 - Rise in military expenditure- less resources for economic development
 - Rising unemployment
 - Minorities, uneducated and unemployed youth were disenchanted with the Congress party, leading to a loss in vote share.
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- Most humiliating defeat of the Congress was in Madras where **DMK turned victorious**. The DMK reserved government jobs for lower castes and food subsidies was granted to the lower castes.
 - They also organized a conference on Tamil culture and language and expressed the hope that **Tamil would become the language link of India**.

GENERAL ELECTION OF 1967 - BACKGROUND



- There was lack of public confidence in the government.
- Opposition parties included the Left parties like Communists and Socialists, Right parties like Jana Sangh and Swatantra Party and regional parties like DMK in Madras and Akali dal in Punjab.
- In Kerala, the Left defeated Congress. In 1963, the Communist Party split into two factions- when the Communist Party of India (Marxist) broke out from it. The CPI was closer to the Communist Party of Soviet Union.

NON-CONGRESSISM



कांग्रेस
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- The opposition parties, used this opportunity to unite against the Congress party.
- They were hopeful because of lack of unity and support for Indira Gandhi within Congress.
- This was called Non-Congressism by Ram Manohar Lohia.

According to Non-Congressism, Democracy needed to be restored:

- The Congress rule was undemocratic
- It did not serve the interests of the ordinary people.

1967

WHICH PARTY WON HOW MANY SEATS IN INDIA'S

4th LOK SABHA ELECTION



ELECTION VERDICT



Congress won with over 40% vote share, but seats were reduced from 361/494 to 283/520

1 Congress won majority in the 1967 elections but with less votes and seats as compared to previous elections.

2 Congress lost majority in the states of and Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Bihar, West Bengal, Orissa, Madras and Kerala and there were defections in Haryana.

3 Tamil Nadu was the state with non-Congress party gaining majority - Dravida Munnetra Kazgham came to power after students led an anti-Hindi agitation against imposition of Hindi language.

4 The remaining non-Congress states had coalition - several non-Congress parties came together to form Samyukt Vidhayak Dal (SVD) or joint legislative parties, since no single party got majority

- Bihar- SSP + PSP + CPI +Jana Sangh
- Punjab- Popular Front government- Sant Group + Master group + CPI +CPI(M) +SSP + Republican Party + Bhartiya Jana Sangh

ELECTION VERDICT



5

Defection:

When an elected representative leave the party on whose platform he/she was elected and joins another party.

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- The leaders defected and installed non-Congress governments in Haryana, UP and MP.
- The continuous shifts and switches between parties- 'Aya Ram, Gaya Ram'.
- Constitution was later amended to stop defections.
- There was a realization that Congress party could be defeated in elections.

FACTIONS WITHIN CONGRESS

- Indira Gandhi had to face opposition from a faction from within her own party called 'Syndicate'.
- They controlled party's organization and were an influential group.
- They decided Indira Gandhi's Council of Ministers.
- These included—K Kamaraj, SK Patil, S Nijalingappa, N. Sanjeeva Reddy and Atulya Ghosh.
- Eventually Indira Gandhi asserted her position and choose a group of people from within the Congress as her confidante, called 'Requisitionists'.

CHALLENGES BEFORE INDIRA GANDHI



- Assert her position within Congress and build her independence from Syndicate.
- Regain ground after the poor performance of the party in the 1967 elections.

STEPS TAKEN BY INDIRA GANDHI



She decided to give the government policy a Left orientation - Congress Working Committee adopted a Ten Point Programme in May 1967.

- Social control of banking – Nationalisation of fourteen private banks
- Abolition of Privy Purses
- Nationalisation of General Insurance
- Ceiling on Urban property and income
- Public distribution of food grains
- Land reforms
- Provision of house sites to rural poor
- Guaranteed minimum wages for industrial and rural labor.

Indira Gandhi believed in the greater role for the state in the economy as it was necessary for social equity and promotion of national integration. This was also because the regional and linguistic identity was helping the rich to get richer and poor to remain poor.

ABOLITION OF PRIVY PURSE



- When their states merged with the Union, the princes were given a constitutional guarantee that they could retain their titles, jewels and palaces, be paid an annual privy purse in proportion to the size of their states and be exempt from central taxes and import duties.
- But with poverty widely prevalent across the country, it was felt that these privileges had to be abolished.
- In 1967, the All India Congress Committee (AICC) passed a resolution asking for an end of titles and privy purses.
- But that initiative could not make a change.
- Ultimately in May 1970, the bill for the Abolition of Privy purse brought and finally passed in the Parliament

SUPREME COURT ON PRIVY PURSE



- On 5th September 1970, a bill to abolish the practice of Privy Purses in India lost by one vote to reach the one-third majority in Rajya Sabha.
 - Simultaneously, the Supreme Court stated that the derecognition of Privy Purses is unconstitutional.
 - This led to certain decisions which changed the fate of the country's constitutional history.
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- Right after the Supreme Court's verdict, Indira Gandhi was furious with the decision and called for fresh elections.
 - The famous '*Garibi Hatao*' slogan was roaring across the country and the Iron Lady of India came back to power with a stunning 352 Lok Sabha seat mandate.
 - This was the beginning of the infamous constitutional changes, one of them being the abolition of privy purses.

CRITICISM OF TEN POINT PROGRAM



- Morarji Desai opposed bank nationalization as he thought it would reduce the resources for economic development, increase bureaucratic control and red tapism.
- Gandhi argued that credit from banks should no longer be a privilege for the rich but should also be accessible to the poor.
- These policies did not appeal to the Old command of the Congress party, but the young generation found them progressive and equitable.
- The rural poor also supported these policies. New branches were opened in the rural and remote areas of India.

PRESIDENTIAL ELECTION OF 1969



V V GIRI

Votes obtained:
4,01,515

**B
E
A
T**



N SANJEEVA REDDY

Votes obtained:
3,13,548

- There was a disagreement over the nomination for the post of the President.
- Syndicate nominated the then Lok Sabha Speaker N Sanjeeva Reddy, whereas Indira Gandhi nominated then Vice President, V V Giri.

Eventually VV Giri became the President of India in 1969.

1971 ELECTIONS

- 1 Indira Gandhi's government was reduced to a minority government after 1969.
- 2 She received support from CPI and DMK. Government implemented the existing land reform laws and furthered land ceiling legislation.
- 3 For legitimising her control and gaining support for her policies, Indira Gandhi dissolved the Lok Sabha in 1970 and the fifth general elections took place in 1971.

- 4 The New Congress had developed an issue and an agenda. Indira Gandhi had put forward a famous slogan- 'Garibi Hatao'.
- 5
 - This helped her gather a support base among the disadvantaged especially landless labourers, Dalits and Adivasis.
 - She focused on
 - ✓ Growth of public sector
 - ✓ Imposition of ceiling on rural land holdings and urban property
 - ✓ Removal of disparities in income and opportunity
 - ✓ Abolition of princely privileges.

1971 ELECTIONS



बेटा कार बनाता है
मां बेकार बढ़ाती है
बोलो समाजवाद की जय
इन्दिरा कांग्रेस के पांच वर्षों के शासन में बेकारों की संख्या
दो करोड़ से बढ़कर साढ़े चार करोड़ हो गई है।
देखा समाजवाद का नारा
मोफत बुल्डोज़ अरोड़ा

**SLOGAN OF THE
OPPOSITION**

**INDIRA
HATAO**

**SLOGAN OF THE
DECADE**

**GARIBI
HATAO**

- These helped Indira Gandhi develop an independent political strategy.
- But there was serious opposition against the New Congress.
- All the non-Communists, non-Congress opposition parties formed an electoral alliance - the Grand Alliance comprising SSP, PSP, Bhartiya Jana Sangh, Swatantra Party and Bhartiya Kranti Dal.
- This Grand Alliance, however, did not have a coherent political agenda except 'Indira Hatao'.

OUTCOME OF 1971 ELECTION



- The Congress(R) -CPI won more seats and votes than the Congress had ever won - 375 seats with 48.4 percent votes.
- The Old Congress secured less than one-fourth of the votes. This result made Indira Gandhi the real leader and her party the real Congress.
- Internal consolidation was enhanced by her reputation and her expediency with regards to the Bangladesh problem. It strengthened her popularity.
- The Congress eventually swept all the states and established a dominant position.
- But the opposition, not accommodated within Congress, created unrests and mobilized public opinion against Congress.

STRONGER CONGRESS



"My father was a statesman, I am a political woman. My father was a saint. I am not."

Indira Gandhi

- 1 Indira Gandhi re-invented the party as it became popular just like it was in the past.
- 2 Only difference being that in 1971 it was because of a supreme leader.
- 3 The party did not have several factions to accommodate diverse interest.
- 4 Instead it garnered support from social groups Dalits, Adivasis, poor, women and minorities.

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